Website brief template

Fill it in before you ask for quotes: 12 sections, a sitemap, an SEO section with redirects, budget and timeline.

How to use this template

1. Complete the brief before you request quotes. One person owns the document and collects answers from sales and customer support.
2. Be specific: what should happen, for whom, and how you will measure it. Skip adjectives like “modern” or “professional.”
3. If you don’t know an answer yet, write “to be decided.” A brief with a few gaps sent today beats a perfect one sent next month.
4. Fill in section 8 (SEO) with the person who has access to Google Search Console and Google Analytics 4.
5. Add the attachments listed in section 12 and send the same brief to every vendor. Ask for proposals in the same format.

Company: _____ Date: _____ Completed by: _____

1. Company and offer

1.1 Company name: _____

1.2 Current website (if any): _____

1.3 Contact person (name, role, email, phone): _____

1.4 What do you do? Describe it in 2–3 sentences, the way you would to a customer on the phone.

_____

_____

_____

1.5 Main services or products, ranked by importance to sales.

_____

_____

_____

1.6 Where you operate:

☐ city or district ☐ region ☐ nationwide ☐ international, which countries: _____

1.7 What sets you apart from competitors? Facts, not adjectives (experience, warranty, lead time, certifications).

_____

_____

2. Goals and KPIs

2.1 Main goal of the site (pick up to two):

☐ form inquiries ☐ phone calls ☐ online sales ☐ bookings ☐ hiring ☐ brand

☐ other: _____

2.2 What should change 6 and 12 months after launch?

2.3 How will you measure it (GA4 form events, calls, orders, applications)?

2.4 Why are you changing the site now? What doesn't work in the current one?

3. Target customers

3.1 Who are your customers (industry and company size, or personal profile)?

3.2 Who makes the buying decision, and who does the research?

3.3 What do customers ask before contacting you? List 5–10 questions (ask your sales and support teams).

3.4 Where do customers come from today?

☐ Google ☐ Google Maps ☐ referrals ☐ social media ☐ ads ☐ trade shows
☐ other: _____

3.5 What stops them from getting in touch or buying?

4. Competitors and inspiration

List a few competitor sites (C) and a few sites you like (I). For each one, add a sentence on what exactly you like or want to avoid.

Website address	C / I	What you like	What to avoid

5. Scope and sitemap

5.1 Pages: the purpose and one main keyword for each (two pages with the same keyword compete).

Add your own rows. The number and types of pages are a major cost driver.

Page	Purpose	Main keyword	Content
Home			☐ ready ☐ to write
Service / product 1			☐ ready ☐ to write
Service / product 2			☐ ready ☐ to write
Service / product 3			☐ ready ☐ to write
About			☐ ready ☐ to write
Projects / case studies			☐ ready ☐ to write
Blog / resources			☐ ready ☐ to write
Contact			☐ ready ☐ to write

5.2 Languages:

☐ one language ☐ English and Polish ☐ other: _____

5.3 Estimated number of pages at launch: _____

5.4 Location pages (cities, neighborhoods), each with its own content: _____

6. Content and assets

6.1 Website copy:

☐ we write it ☐ the vendor writes it ☐ shared

6.2 Photos:

☐ our own ☐ a photo shoot is needed ☐ stock photos

6.3 What you already have (check):

☐ Vector logo (SVG, PDF, AI)
☐ Brand guidelines
☐ Customer reviews with permission to publish
☐ Projects, case studies, portfolio
☐ Certifications, awards, memberships
☐ Video
☐ Copy from the current site worth reusing
☐ Details for the privacy policy and terms

6.4 Who approves the copy, and how long they need: _____

7. Features and integrations

7.1 What the site needs (check and add details):

☐ Contact form, fields: _____
☐ File upload in the form (photos, documents)
☐ Calculator or configurator
☐ Online booking / calendar
☐ Online payments or store
☐ CRM, which one: _____
☐ Newsletter, platform: _____
☐ Live chat
☐ Client login area
☐ Site search
☐ Accounting or ERP integration
☐ Other: _____

7.2 Describe the most important feature: what it does, who uses it and what it connects to.

8. SEO: keywords, traffic, redirects, local SEO

8.1 Most important keywords: your services as customers describe them (ask your sales team and check Google's search suggestions). Map each keyword to one page.

Keyword (e.g. service + city)	Target page	Priority 1–3

8.2 Access to Google Search Console:

☐ yes ☐ no ☐ not sure

8.3 Access to Google Analytics 4:

☐ yes ☐ no ☐ not sure

8.4 Pages with the most traffic and the most leads (attach a 12-month Search Console export and GA4 data):

8.5 Will page URLs change?

☐ yes ☐ no ☐ not sure

Who prepares the redirect map: _____

Redirect map: every old URL points with a permanent redirect (301 or 308) to its closest equivalent on the new site, not to the homepage in bulk.

Old URL	New URL	Notes
/	/	

8.6 Google Business Profile: link, address and service area (the business name, address and phone on the site must match the profile).

8.7 Tracking visibility in ChatGPT and Google AI Overviews:

☐ yes ☐ no ☐ let's discuss

8.8 Ongoing SEO work or ad campaigns that must not be interrupted:

SEO checklist before moving the site (if it is already live)

- ☐ Export of top pages and queries from Search Console (12 months)
- ☐ List of pages that generate leads (GA4)
- ☐ Full list of current URLs (sitemap, CMS, Search Console)
- ☐ Redirect map: old URL → closest equivalent
- ☐ Owner of the domain and Google accounts confirmed
- ☐ Launch date outside your peak sales period

SEO requirements at handover and on launch day

- ☐ Content and links in the HTML Google sees (URL Inspection in Search Console)
- ☐ Same content on mobile and desktop
- ☐ LCP up to 2.5 s, INP up to 200 ms, CLS up to 0.1 (web.dev thresholds)
- ☐ Unique title and meta description, one H1 per page
- ☐ Staging password-protected; noindex and robots.txt blocks removed on launch day
- ☐ Redirects tested, with no chains, and kept for at least a year (Google's advice)
- ☐ Internal links updated to the new URLs
- ☐ New sitemap submitted in Search Console
- ☐ Business name, address and phone match the Google Business Profile
- ☐ Analytics and key events work from launch day

9. Design and brand

9.1 Brand colors and fonts (if any): _____

9.2 Three words that describe the feel of the site: _____

9.3 What you definitely don't want (colors, style, elements):

_____

_____

9.4 Accessibility requirements (for example, public sector, older or low-vision users):

_____

9.5 How customers view the site:

☐ mostly phone ☐ mostly desktop ☐ both equally ☐ not sure

10. Technical setup: domain, hosting, CMS

10.1 Access: who owns each item and who holds the login? Your company should be the owner, with the vendor added as a user. Check before you send the brief.

Item	Provider / account	Owner / who has access	Notes
Domain			
Hosting			
Email			
Google Search Console			
Google Analytics 4			
Google Business Profile			
Tag manager, ad pixels			

10.2 Content management system:

☐ no preference ☐ specific: _____

Who will edit content, and how often: _____

10.3 Legal and security requirements (GDPR, cookies, terms):

10.4 Maintenance after launch:

☐ in-house ☐ the vendor ☐ to be decided

11. Budget and deadline

11.1 Build budget (net range): from _____ to _____ net

11.2 Monthly budget for maintenance, content or SEO: _____

11.3 Target launch date and the reason for it (trade show, campaign, season). If the site gets Google traffic, avoid launching in your peak sales period:

11.4 Periods when decision makers are unavailable (vacations, peak season):

12. Decision makers, contact and attachments

12.1 People and roles:

Role	Name	Email / phone
Project owner		
Approves the design		
Approves the copy		
Decides on budget		

12.2 How long you need to approve one stage: _____

12.3 Preferred contact:

☐ email ☐ video calls ☐ in-person meetings

12.4 Attachments to the brief:

☐ Search Console export
☐ Logo
☐ Photos
☐ Sample copy
☐ Wireframe or page sketch
☐ Other: _____